

Overview of Health Data Standards

Health data standards are essential for ensuring that information about patients and healthcare processes can be shared, understood, and used across different systems and organizations. The Meta Data and Data Standards (MDDS) for the health domain define common data elements, code directories, and metadata. These standards enable interoperability between hospitals, clinics, laboratories, and government agencies. By standardizing patient demographics, clinical observations, diagnoses, and procedures, MDDS supports the development of electronic health records (EHRs) and health information exchanges (HIEs). Adopting these standards improves patient safety, reduces errors, and enables better public health surveillance.